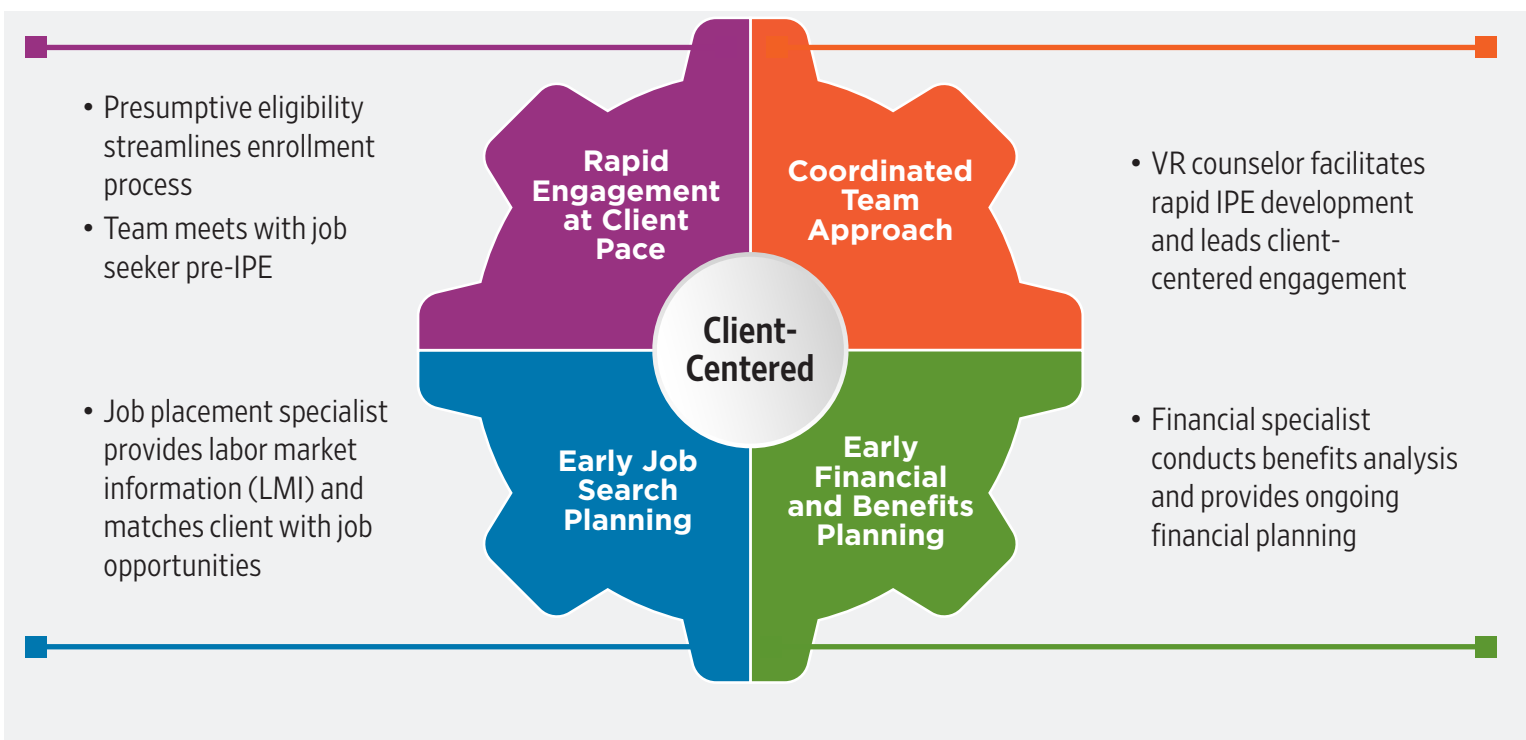


Improving Employment and Wage Outcomes for People Receiving SSDI

The Rapid Engagement Team Approach (RETA) Project promotes the use of an evidence-based vocational rehabilitation (VR) practice that advances employment for job seekers with disabilities who receive Social Security Disability Insurance (SSDI).

Housed at the Institute for Community Inclusion (ICI) at the University of Massachusetts Boston, the RETA Project partners with VR agencies to implement the model, which has been shown to increase the chances that SSDI beneficiaries achieve earnings above the Substantial Gainful Activity (SGA) level.

What is the Rapid Engagement Team Approach (RETA) Model?



Why RETA?

A randomized controlled trial tested the Rapid Engagement Team Approach (RETA) and found that VR customers who received services through the model were more likely to:

- have a signed Individualized Plan for Employment (IPE) within 30 days of application
- obtain competitive employment
- achieve earnings at or above SGA

An in-depth qualitative study found that the model helped VR customers make informed decisions about their paths forward with less anxiety about losing benefits.



ExploreVR 

Rapid Engagement Team Approach (RETA) Project

INSTITUTE FOR COMMUNITY INCLUSION, UMASS BOSTON

www.explorevr.org/RETA



RETA Project Goals

Increased adoption of the RETA model, informed by:

- SSDI beneficiaries' lived experiences
- VR agency implementation; addressing barriers and facilitators

Improved services for job seekers, including:

- shorter wait times
- plans informed by work incentives counseling and local labor market information (LMI)

Employment with higher earnings, which:

- maximizes economic independence
- improves quality of life

RETA Project Activities

- Host a Learning Collaborative with VR agencies piloting RETA
- Provide site-level technical assistance to support implementation
- Gather perspectives of VR clients to embed their lived experience into RETA
- Develop and disseminate a toolkit to help VR agencies apply RETA in their offices

ABOUT

The RETA Project is a 3-year development grant at the Institute for Community Inclusion at UMass Boston, funded by the National Institute on Disability, Independent Living, and Rehabilitation Research (NIDILRR grant number 90DPEM0014). NIDILRR is a Center within the Administration for Community Living (ACL), Department of Health and Human Services (HHS). The contents of this fact sheet do not necessarily represent the policy of NIDILRR, ACL, or HHS, and you should not assume endorsement by the Federal Government.

FOR MORE INFORMATION

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